

Rep. Tom Emmer on Mornings With Maria

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****MARIA BARTIROMO:**

** Joining me now is Minnesota Congressman and House Majority Whip, Tom Emmer. And Congressman, great to see you. We so appreciate your time. Before I get to that, I want to ask you what you, I don't know if you just heard my last guest. We had David Bozell on. He was from the MRC Media Research Center. And he said that there's so many negative headlines on these quote unquote news apps from like Yahoo and Google and Apple and increasingly younger people are getting information from those news apps, but there's an overwhelming negative tone about the Republicans on those news apps. And he said that will shift votes. What are you going to do going into the midterm elections about these negative headlines around the Republicans that seem to be permeating through these technology apps?

****REP. TOM EMMER:**

** Wow, Maria, great to be with you. All I could think of when your prior guest was talking is he could have done a case study on the Minnesota Tribune, which should be called the Tim Walz Tribune. Do you realize the other night Tim Walz gave his last State of the State and the headline was Walz frames his legacy. There was no mention of the billions of dollars of fraud. This has been a problem for a long time. The president has broken this, the hex that the media has on the public. Americans are very suspicious of their news sources. You're right about young people and how do we one. We are 435 pieces of geography with unique demographics in each one. Our incumbents, our candidates need to figure out what the message is that moves their voters in their state. And then they need to use the media that's available. And it's all different kinds, right? If you're in the age group 55 to 85, you're going to want a newspaper or some more traditional thing. If you're 18 to 45, you're streaming, you're doing all kinds of other things. So we got to be up with our game. But it's about getting our message to people, because guess what? The American people are much smarter than even these corrupt left wing journalists are. And that's why we've been successful the last several election cycles.

****MARIA BARTIROMO:**

** Well, I mean, you're spot on. I mean, it's about the messaging. I mean, look, let's face it. The economy is doing very well, even in the face of higher gas prices and higher oil prices. You've got Jay Powell, who's not exactly a friend of President Trump, but he had to admit yesterday, Jay Powell at the Fed meeting, that the economy is incredibly resilient, that consumer spending is just plowing along. And this move in oil prices has not had the impact that all the naysayers have said. You got Treasury Secretary Scott Besson talking about the impact of tax day and the impact of the president's policies. Are you going to be able to message all of that out in a practical way to reach the people you need to reach going into the midterms, or are you going to allow the midterms to come and go? You lose seats and the president's agenda gets busted.

****REP. TOM EMMER:**

** Yeah, no, we're we're here to hold our majority and expand it, Maria. And the way you're going to do that first, it's perception and reality. You just started talking about the reality. The reality is there is all kinds of great news

in our economy. The problem is the perception of the average American citizen has not intersected with that reality quite yet. If you take a look at tax day, that was the beginning of how people actually are feeling it directly. No taxes on tips, no taxes on overtime. As this thing builds and you start to see the celebrations that our great president is planning for this country on its 250th birthday, and as you get those billions that you were talking about earlier on your program that are being injected into our economy right now. By the time we hit that August, September, October period, perception and reality will intersect. And guess what? We're going to have more than a message. By the way, I've got to mention this. They keep talking about affordability. It's always about the economy, stupid. It always has been. If the economy is performing and people do this emotional thing in September when they're going to vote, where they get up and they say, do I feel better about where I am today than I did when this started? And do I see a bright economic future? Guess what, Maria? They vote for more of what they have. And that's why I'm confident we're going to hold our majority in the House and we're going to actually expand it.

****MARIA BARTIROMO:**

** All right. It's good to see you have the plans in place. Let's talk about the business at hand, Congressman, because you said the last time you joined me that House Speaker Mike Johnson was was was intending to have another reconciliation package closer to the midterms after you get through this current situation where right now you are looking to fund DHS. You want to fund, of course, you want to pass the three year extension of FISA Section 702. What happened in terms of the funding of Customs and Border Patrol and ICE this week?

****REP. TOM EMMER:**

** Well, you got to go back to the fact that this is because Chuck Schumer and Democrats hate law enforcement, and in particular, they hate federal law enforcement. They've shut down the Department of Homeland Security now for 80 to 90 days already. I don't even know the exact number. This is a record shutdown. We know that when it comes to the Immigration and Customs Enforcement and the Border Patrol, they are in a bad situation. Their last paycheck is coming, I believe, this week, today. We've got to make sure they get funded in spite of the Democrats' refusal to put American safety first. So what's happened? Last night, we passed a FISA reauthorization bill with 42 Democrats. Only 42 Democrats voted for this last night. It's over in the Senate. Now we'll see what they do. I'm confident we're going to get that done on the FISA side before it goes dark tonight. On the DHS side, we had a spirited discussion over several hours last night about the budget resolution and the future as we go forward. And all kinds of different voices were being heard. It was about farm country, because Republicans' constituency in rural America is hurting badly. So that was one of the aspects. It was about Reconciliation 3. But at the end of the day, guess what? We got both of them done, and today we're going to pass a farm bill. And yes, our speaker is committed to doing a Reconciliation 3.0. And interestingly, we started to hear some comments coming from the other side of the building with our senators that they may be interested in that also. That would be very helpful.

****MARIA BARTIROMO:**

** Well, I mean, like most people from the outside look in and they say, we don't understand why. How is it possible that the Republicans are not all unified in just funding ICE and Customs and Border Patrol?

****REP. TOM EMMER:**

** We are unified. The issue is not that. The issue really is there's a division within the conference about we've got to get this done today. And others that believe that we can add other things to this, right? Because this is just a slim budget proposal. We're not even calling it a reconciliation bill. This is an actual appropriations funding bill because Democrats have refused to participate. So we've got to have a tool to pass it with only Republican

votes. That was the disagreement. But it's not a disagreement about funding ICE. Our members are committed to making sure that we protect American safety first.

****MARIA BARTIROMO:**

** Yeah, exactly. And it's unbelievable that you have to use a reconciliation package to ensure that ICE is open and funded and Customs and Border Patrol. But, you know, you mentioned Tim Walz earlier. He's trying now to take credit for the FBI's investigation into statewide fraud, which included, of course, raids of Minneapolis businesses earlier this week. Take a look at this. Got to get your reaction. We've created additional checks and balances. We've brought on more investigators, more auditors, more law enforcement agencies, as well as an outside firm to take a look at high risk programs. People who have ripped us off are getting caught and they are going to jail. I've said the buck stops with me. And as I know, some of you will take that as an open invitation to play politics with every incident of fraud that takes place here in Minnesota. Even though I have to tell you, statistics show it's happening in red states more than here. But so be it. Red states more than here, Congressman, your reaction as as right now, you know, you tweeted the only thing Governor Walsh should be claiming credit for is allowing nine billion dollars of taxpayer funds to be stolen under his watch. It looks like he's getting religion here about the fraud.

****REP. TOM EMMER:**

** Maria, this guy has no religion except the altar of Tim Walz, everything. You can't believe a word that comes out of this man's mouth. He lied about his military career. He's lied about. I mean, he got caught on national TV lying about something as dumb as when he was at Tiananmen Square. And what was his answer back in that debate with J.D. Vance? He said, well, you know, sometimes I come from a small town and sometimes I'm a bit of a knucklehead. You know what? That's no excuse for being a liar. And when he says that the buck stops with him, I agree, because it's as much as nine billion dollars has gone out under his watch in just the last seven and a half years. And all this garbage he's doing at the end is more fraud on his behalf. Think about this. Over 20 raids of Somali fraudsters conducted by the FBI, conducted by the Department of Justice just this week to daycare centers and autism centers. And what does Tim Walz do and our corrupt attorney general? They try to take credit for the raids that are happening. Guess what? They had nothing to do with it. In fact, they have tried to sweep this under the rug forever. This was the reason that they were so adamant about the surge, because it took this topic off the headlines. Well, guess what? It's back. And he's going to have to answer for it. I'm glad he's acknowledging that he's the one that is going to have to answer for this.

****MARIA BARTIROMO:**

** Unbelievable. Conference. Good to see you. We're going to be watching your work as always. Thank you, sir.

****REP. TOM EMMER:**

** Thanks, Maria.

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